

ECUADOR

Age - 24

Club - Paris Saint-Germain

Int. caps - 34

William Pacho

Ecuador's run in the South American qualifiers was one for the ages. It wasn't finishing second, ahead of giants Brazil and Uruguay, which surprised most, but rather that it conceded just five goals in 18 qualifying matches. One of the central pillars of this feat was Willian Pacho (**left**), who played every single minute of the qualifiers to rally his side to a second consecutive finals appearance.

Pacho, who has been playing in France with Paris Saint-Germain since 2024, has contributed to the club's brightest period, during which it won the treble, including a maiden UEFA Champions League title.

Under Luis Enrique, Pacho joined forces

with Brazilian Marquinhos as part of the club's spine and developed into a level-headed player with excellent defensive intelligence. In the ongoing Champions League season, he leads the list for ball recoveries (90) as his club aims to defend its European crown.

But what really stands out this season is his disciplinary record. Despite playing over 3,000 minutes across all competitions, the 24-year-old has not been booked once — a rarity, especially for a central defender. While he watched his team crash out of the previous edition in Qatar from the bench, this time around he will be a towering presence in an Ecuador side looking to improve on its Round of 16 appearance in 2006.

